



Checking understanding of algebraic notation

Task A: Missing number problems

1) Solve each problem, you could use a diagram to help you.

a) A recipe for fruit cake requires the same amount of currants and sultanas but twice as many raisins.

Altogether you need 420 g of dried fruit.

How much of each fruit do you need?

c) A rectangle is drawn where its length is double its width.

If its perimeter is 24 cm, what is the area of the rectangle?

2a) Sour sweets cost 30 p and toffees cost 25 p.

Laura has £1.70 and wants to spend all her money with no change left over.

How many of each can she buy?

b) Jacob was 6 years old when his puppy was born.

At what age would he be exactly double his puppy's age?

At what age would he be exactly three times his puppy's age?

d) The length of a rectangular cupboard is 1 m longer than its width.

The perimeter of the cupboard floor is 9 m; what is its area?

Leave your answer as a fraction.

b) Sam has written the equation

$$2a + 3b = 26$$



Sam

There are two answers to this problem.

$a = 4$ and $b = 6$ or

$a = 1$ and $b = 8$

Explain why Sam is incorrect.

Task B: Expressing problems algebraically

1) Match the bar model to the equation.

a)

a				
x	x	x	x	5

$$a + 5 = a + 4x$$

b)

5				
x	x	x	x	a

$$2a + 5 = 4x + 3$$

c)

a		a		5
x	x	x	x	3

$$5 = 4x + a$$

d)

a		5		
x	x	x	x	a

$$4x + 5 = a$$

e)

5		x	a
x	x	3	a

$$a + 2x + 3 = a + x + 5$$

2) Match the statements to the equations.

a) A number minus 2 then divided by 5 equals 20

$$\frac{x}{5} - 2 = 20$$

b) A number divided by 5 then minus 2 equals 20

$$\frac{2}{x - 5} = 20$$

c) 2 divided by 5 less than a number equals 20

$$\frac{2}{x} - 5 = 20$$

d) 2 divided by a number then minus 5 equals 20

$$\frac{2 - x}{5} = 20$$

e) A number subtracted from 2 then divided by 5 equals 20

$$\frac{x - 2}{5} = 20$$